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MEMO

Date: June 4, 2026

To: Superintendent Armstrong

From: Senior Chief Franco

Subject: Update for Sunsetting Dual Assignment: Jefferson is Rising

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On January 13, 2026 the Board of Education voted to sunset the dual assignment zone (Resolution No. 7228) that was shared with Grant, Jefferson, McDaniel and Roosevelt High School. A second resolution was passed that also established an attendance area (Resolution No. 7229) for the Jefferson High School to a comprehensive neighborhood high school starting in the 2027-28 school year. This is the first annual update on implementation. We are sharing updates in the following areas: Academics, Athletics and Engagement.

Academics
Jefferson staff are working intentionally to build academic programming that will move the school from a focus option to a comprehensive neighborhood high school. Academic Programs staff have partnered closely with Jefferson High School administrators to develop a long-term vision for academic programming aligned with projected enrollment growth.

A central element of this work is a 2.0 FTE investment designed to strategically build programming in anticipation of increased student enrollment. Jefferson will introduce Pre-AP for ninth graders and AP Seminar for tenth graders. Smaller classes at these levels will afford greater student support allowing students to develop the skills and knowledge to access college level coursework as juniors.

Jefferson remains committed to a strong dual-credit partnership with Portland Community College (PCC). Offering both Dual Credit and AP pathways allows Jefferson to better meet the diverse needs, interests, and postsecondary goals of our students.

Jefferson will launch a Construction Carpentry program in 2026-27, creating a new Career and Technical Education pathway for students interested in the skilled trades which will include beginning, intermediate, and advanced levels allowing students to become CTE completers.

Key activities to date include:

- Collaborative planning meetings with Jefferson administrators to review enrollment and forecasting data, evaluate existing course offerings, and identify priorities for the 2026-27 school year.
- Implementation planning for the addition of AP Seminar and a Construction CTE pathway for the 2026-27 school year, including course sequencing, staffing considerations, and alignment with district priorities.

- Administering YouScience aptitude and career interest assessments at both Jefferson HS and Harriet Tubman MS to provide student-centered data that will inform future pathway development and academic planning.
- Engaging external partners, including higher education, industry, and non-profit organizations, to explore innovative approaches to pathway design and career-connected learning opportunities for Jefferson's students.
- Drafting a comprehensive academic programming framework that identifies college preparation, Career and Technical Education, visual and performing arts, and strategic partnerships as foundational elements of Jefferson's future academic model.
- Identifying students accessing Special Education services in the feeder schools and working with the Special Education department to prepare classrooms, and outlining physical and instructional resources needed to provide a full continuum of services in the 2027-28 school year.

Athletics

Portland Interscholastic League (PIL) Athletics staff met with Jefferson High School administrators and others to create a plan to develop and support athletic programs at Jefferson High School and Jefferson Youth Sports.

Keys activities to date include:

- Planning with Jefferson principal, athletic director, and middle school feeder school principals to:
  - Create of entry level experience at the middle school level
  - Develop a peer mentoring program with high school and middle school athletes
  - Develop "Youth Night" activities at the high school level
- Meeting with high school head coaches on June 11, 2026 to:
  - Share the vision for Jefferson is Rising
  - Identify opportunities to strengthen connection with middle and elementary age students/families
- Developing the plan outlined below for adding levels or programs.

	2026-27	2027-28
Boys Soccer	JV2	JV/JV2
Girls Soccer	JV2	JV/JV2
Baseball	Varsity	Var/JV
Softball	JV2	JV/JV2
Boys Golf	Student Interest	
Girls Golf	Student Interest	
Boys Tennis	Student Interest	
Girls Tennis	Student Interest	

Engagement

Throughout the spring the staff at Jefferson worked closely with families, feeder school administrators and students to strengthen connections. Activities were conducted on site at Jefferson and at feeder schools with middle grades.

Keys activities to date include:

- December: Harriet Tubman 8th grade tour

- February: feeder middle school and Jefferson PTSA meeting, MLC tours, 9th/10th grade Jefferson is Rising meetings with students in AVID classes
- March: Jefferson is Rising all grade assemblies, Vernon 8th grade school tour, modernization meeting
- April: Ockley Green 8th grade tour, CTE students at Vernon STEM event, Woodlawn PTSA, site council meeting
- May: curriculum night and family tours, modernization meeting, groundbreaking ceremony, site council meeting, Jefferson band guest conductor and instructional support with Ockley Green 7th and 8th grade bands